

required a large number of people to create accounts with Google, mostly ending with '@gmail.com'. While Gmail itself has taken hold of almost 24% of the email-client market, second only to the Apple iPhone email client, the Google account has grown to be something synonymous with your experience within the Google ecosystem. If you are a Google account user, who is also enmeshed in the Google ecosystem with an Android phone, a Chrome desktop browser, a Blogger-powered blog and more, then you need not be told how this works. Information is tracked and indexed across the ecosystem so that your experience is seamless and customised to you – regardless of device, activity and intention. Needless to say, there are sufficient arguments on both the usefulness as well as the invasiveness of such a service. With the same account tracking your actions on your phone (Android), desktop (Chrome browser and Chrome OS) and even your home (Google Home), the extent to which Google knows you can be a bit alarming. But if you don't mind your data being used to provide you a service, in lieu of the same data being put to use as a part of a large database to power the web as we know it, then Google is the perfect ecosystem for you.

Beyond the web

While Google has effectively spread its virtual dominion over the web in the course of its existence, it would be wrong to say that no counterpart of the said dominion exists in the real, physical world beyond the internet. Google has enmeshed itself into hardware as well as a host of other areas in the world of science and technology.

Apart from consumer products like smartphones (Nexus and Pixel), laptops (Chromebooks) and home assistants (Google Home) from the main organisation, Google has spread its diverse efforts into other sister organisations – ranging from anti ageing research (Calico) to self driving cars (Waymo) to AI (DeepMind). In fact, it wouldn't be a far stretch to say that the 2015 restructuring that brought Google under Alphabet Inc., while doing the same to Calico, DeepMind, Google Fiber, Nest Labs, Waymo and other former Google subsidiaries, was with the aim of making Google the consumer-front of the entire organisation, while still maintaining a distinct finger in all the pies that Google had ventured into over the years.

A Googled future

No matter which way you look at it, Google seems to have the future figured out (on paper at least). Irrespective of which level of detail you're currently